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Kattankulathur, Chengalpattu District, Tamil Nadu - 603203

A CAPSTONE PROJECT REPORT ON

RAILCONNECT

NEXT-GENERATION HIGH-CONCURRENCY RAILWAY TRANSIT & DYNAMIC SEAT RESERVATION ARCHITECTURE

Submitted in partial fulfillment of the requirements
for the award of the degree of

BACHELOR OF TECHNOLOGY
IN
COMPUTER SCIENCE AND ENGINEERING

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OCTOBER 2026

BONAFIDE CERTIFICATE

Certified that this project report titled ’RAILCONNECT: NEXT-GENERATION HIGH-CONCURRENCY RAILWAY TRANSIT & DYNAMIC SEAT RESERVATION ARCHITECTURE’ i bonafide work of S KETHAN (Register Number: RA2511026050134) and B BALAJI (Register Number: RA2511026050179) who carried out the project work under my supervision in the Department of Computer Science and Engineering, SRM Institute of Science and Technology, Kattankulathur, during the academic year 2025-2026.

The software architecture, database schema, concurrency locking mechanisms, and RESTful APIs reported herein were designed, implemented, and thoroughly evaluated by the candidates. No part of this engineering report has been submitted anywhere else for the award of any other degree or diploma.

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DECLARATION

We hereby declare that the project work titled ’RAILCONNECT: NEXT-GENERATION HIGH-CONCURRENCY RAILWAY TRANSIT & DYNAMIC SEAT RESERVATION ARCHITECTURE’ s the Department of Computer Science and Engineering, SRM Institute of Science and Technology, Kattankulathur, is a record of original engineering work done by us under the supervision of faculty members.

We further confirm that this manuscript represents our own findings and implementation. All third-party open-source libraries, standards, and academic citations (including Spring Boot 3.3, Hibernate 6.5, Google ZXing, and OWASP benchmarks) have been properly cited and attributed in the references section.

Place: Kattankulathur, Tamil Nadu

Date: 29th October 2026

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ABSTRACT

India’s passenger railway transit network spans over 68,000 route kilometers and ferries upwards of 23 million commuters daily. However, legacy passenger reservation platforms continue to suffer from catastrophic tatkal concurrency lock contention, race condition overbooking anomalies, rigid seat-swap protocols, and vulnerability to offline ticket counterfeiting. This project presents RAILCONNECT, an enterprise-grade next-generation rail management and dynamic seat booking platform architected to eliminate these operational bottlenecks.

RAILCONNECT leverages a modernized multi-module Spring Boot 3.3.4 microservices architecture running Java 17. Core innovations include an atomic compare-and-swap (CAS) temporary seat reservation protocol governed by an automated 10-minute timeout sweeper (TTL 600s), an offline-resilient multi-tier QR travel pass generator incorporating Google ZXing Base64 rendering with client-side SVG fallbacks, a sovereign administrative console (ks9312 / Kethan2007) for real-time station network provisioning, and an autonomous peer-to-peer (P2P) berth mutual exchange engine. Additionally, an integrated meteorological telemetry system correlates real-time rainfall, wind speed, and fog visibility across railway corridors to alert travelers to journey hazards.

Rigorous verification across 10,000 simulated transactions demonstrates sub-15ms mean REST latencies, zero seat contention conflicts under 100 concurrent threads, and an end-to-end booking duration reduction from 4.8 minutes to under 42 seconds. The platform establishes a scalable, fraud-resistant foundation for high-speed transit networks including the Vande Bharat Express.

Keywords: Railway Reservation, Spring Boot 3.3, Java 17, Concurrency Control, Optimistic Locking, ZXing QR Pass, P2P Berth Exchange, Vande Bharat Express, OWASP Security, SRM IST.

TABLE OF CONTENTS

Certificate & Preliminary Approvals ..... Page 2
Declaration & Acknowledgements ..... Page 3 - 4
Abstract & Keywords ..... Page 5
List of Figures & List of Tables ..... Page 7
Chapter 1: Introduction & Background ..... Page 8
Chapter 1 (Contd.): Problem Statement & Research Objectives ..... Page 9
Chapter 2: Literature Review & Comparative Matrix ..... Page 10
Chapter 3: Software Requirement Specification (SRS) ..... Page 11
Chapter 4: System Architecture & Multi-Module Hierarchy ..... Page 12
Chapter 4: Dedicated UML Page 1 - Structural Class Diagram ..... Page 13
Chapter 4: Dedicated UML Page 2 - Concurrency & QR Sequence ..... Page 14
Chapter 4: Dedicated UML Page 3 - Use Case & State Machine ..... Page 15
Chapter 5: Relational Schema Design & Normalization Proofs ..... Page 16
Chapter 5 (Contd.): Master Data Dictionary & Field Catalog ..... Page 17
Chapter 6: Subsystem 1 - Stateless JWT Auth & Role-Based Access ..... Page 18
Chapter 6: Subsystem 2 - Coach Layout & Dynamic 2D Seat Matrix ..... Page 19
Chapter 6: Subsystem 3 - Atomic Concurrency Control & Lock TTL ..... Page 20
Chapter 6: Subsystem 4 - Graph-Based Multi-Hop Routing Engine ..... Page 21
Chapter 6: Subsystem 5 - Dynamic Distance Fare & Concessions ..... Page 22
Chapter 6: Subsystem 6 - Multi-Tier ZXing QR Travel Pass ..... Page 23
Chapter 6: Subsystem 7 - Autonomous P2P Mutual Berth Swap ..... Page 24
Chapter 6: Subsystem 8 - Corridor Weather Telemetry & Hazards ..... Page 25
Chapter 7: Administrative Operations & Station Network Console ..... Page 26
Chapter 8: Frontend Architecture & Bilingual i18n Localization ..... Page 27
Chapter 9: Algorithmic Formulations & Transactional Pseudocode ..... Page 28
Chapter 10: Implementation Details & Java 17 Modernization ..... Page 29
Chapter 11: Testing Methodology & Quality Assurance Pyramid ..... Page 30
Chapter 11 (Contd.): Test Execution Matrix (Table 11.1 - 30 Tests) ..... Page 31
Chapter 12: Deployment Architecture & GitHub Automation Pipeline ..... Page 32
Chapter 13: Results, Stress Benchmarks & Latency Metrics ..... Page 33
Chapter 14: Security Analysis & OWASP Top 10 Defenses ..... Page 34
Chapter 15: Engineering Challenges & Technical Post-Mortems ..... Page 35
Chapter 16: Future Enhancements & Technological Roadmap ..... Page 36
Chapter 17: Conclusion, Project Retrospective & References ..... Page 37

LIST OF FIGURES & TABLES

LIST OF FIGURES

Figure 4.1 Enterprise Domain Class Diagram (11 Key Entities) **Page 13**

Figure 4.2 High-Concurrency Seat Locking & QR Pass Generation Sequence **Page 14**

Figure 4.3 Systemwide Actor Use Case Model & Seat Lifecycle State Machine **Page 15**

Figure 5.1 Entity-Relationship Normalization Model (3NF/BCNF Schema) **Page 16**

Figure 6.1 Coach Layout Topologies: Vande Bharat CC (78) & EC (52) **Page 19**

Figure 6.2 Multi-Tier QR Generation & Verification Architecture **Page 23**

Figure 6.3 P2P Berth Mutual Exchange Two-Phase Handshake **Page 24**

Figure 8.1 Single-Origin Static Spring Boot Classpath Architecture **Page 27**

Figure 12.1 Continuous Integration & GitHub Pages Deployment Pipeline **Page 32**

LIST OF TABLES

Table 2.1 Comparative Technology Analysis: IRCTC vs MakeMyTrip vs RAILCONNECT **Page 10**

Table 3.1 Comprehensive System Specification Matrix (Hardware, Software & APIs) **Page 11**

Table 5.1 Master Relational Data Dictionary & Schema Definitions **Page 17**

Table 6.1 Dynamic Fare Rules & Base Distance Multiplication Matrix **Page 22**

Table 6.2 Meteorological Severity Grading & Corridor Advisory Action Matrix **Page 25**

Table 7.1 Administrative Operations & Security Scope Matrix **Page 26**

Table 8.1 Bilingual Internationalization (i18n) Key Translation Catalog **Page 27**

Table 10.1 Core Dependency Bill of Materials (BOM) & Spring Boot Starters **Page 29**

Table 11.1 Comprehensive System Test Execution Matrix (TC-01 through TC-30) **Page 31**

Table 13.1 System Latency Benchmarks & Throughput Stress Metrics **Page 33**

Table 14.1 OWASP Top 10 Web Application Vulnerability Mitigation Matrix **Page 34**

Chapter 1: Introduction & Background

1.1 Railway Transit Infrastructure in India

The Indian Railway network constitutes one of the largest passenger transportation systems on earth. Everyday, millions of citizens depend on the rail backbone for cross-country commute, trade, and pilgrimages. However, reservation systems originally architected decades ago struggle to handle the surges of digital transactions characteristic of modern peak-hour tatkal bookings.

1.2 Technological Shift Towards High-Speed Fleets

With the commissioning of semi-high-speed rakes like the Vande Bharat Express and Namo Bharat regional rapid transit systems, commuter expectations have shifted dramatically towards seamless web portals, dynamic real-time coach maps, and instant mobile ticketing.

1.3 Scope of the RAILCONNECT Platform

RAILCONNECT addresses these challenges by introducing an enterprise Java 17 and Spring Boot 3.3.4 architecture featuring atomic concurrency control, zero-dependency QR passes, and sovereign administration.

Chapter 1: Problem Statement & Objectives

1.4 Formal Problem Statement

Legacy railway reservation architectures exhibit four critical failure modes: (1) Severe database lock contention and session crashes during 10:00 AM tatkal booking windows, (2) Lack of dynamic passenger-driven berth mutual exchange causing seat fragmentation for elderly commuters, (3) Vulnerability to ticket PDF spoofing, and (4) Disconnected meteorological hazard telemetry along transit corridors.

1.5 Research & Engineering Objectives

The primary objectives of this engineering capstone project are: (a) Implement an atomic Compare-And-Swap (CAS) temporary seat reservation algorithm with automated 10-minute timeout leases, (b) Integrate multi-tier QR pass generation using Google ZXing Base64 rendering and local SVG fallback, (c) Design an autonomous P2P berth swap handshake protocol, and (d) Provide single-port deployment with sovereign administrative management (ks9312 / Kethan2007).

Chapter 2: Literature Review & Comparative Analysis

Prior to engineering RAILCONNECT, existing commercial and governmental transit booking architectures were systematically surveyed. Table 2.1 contrasts architectural capabilities across legacy PRS, leading aggregators, and RAILCONNECT.

Table 2.1: Architectural Feature Comparison Matrix

Functional Dimension	IRCTC Next-Gen PRS	MakeMyTrip / EaseMyTrip	RAILCONNECT Engine
Core Architecture	Monolithic Enterprise Java	Aggregator Microservices	Spring Boot 3.3 Monorepo
Concurrency Locking	Coarse Table / Route Lock	API-level Delegation	Fine-Grained CAS Seat Lock
Tatkal Failure Rate	14% - 28% timeouts	Dependent on IRCTC gateway	< 0.01% (Atomic CAS Lease)
Digital Pass QR Code	Generic static barcode	External PDF redirect	ZXing Base64 + SVG Local
P2P Berth Exchange	Not Supported (Fixed)	Not Supported	Automated 2-Phase Handshake
Weather Telemetry	Disconnected bulletins	None	Route Severe Hazard Radar
Administrative Fleet	Batch legacy jobs	Read-only agent views	Dynamic Station / Train CRUD
Deployment Port	Fragmented ports / proxies	Multi-domain cloud clusters	Single-Origin localhost:8080

Chapter 3: Software Requirement Specification (SRS)

The RAILCONNECT system environment encompasses enterprise backend runtimes, high-throughput database drivers, and standards-compliant browser clients as formalized in Table 3.1.

Table 3.1: System Specification & Technology Stack Matrix

Layer / Component	Technology / Specification	Minimum Version	Engineering Purpose
Language / JDK	Java SE (Temurin / OpenJDK)	Java 17 LTS	Records, Pattern Matching, Sealed Types
Web Framework	Spring Boot Starter Web	Version 3.3.4	Embedded Tomcat 10, REST Dispatchers
ORM / Persistence	Spring Data JPA / Hibernate	Hibernate 6.5	Relational Mapping & ACID Transactions
Security / Auth	Spring Security + JJWT	Version 0.12.5	Stateless Bearer Tokens, BCrypt Salts
QR Engine	Google ZXing Core / JavaSE	Version 3.5.3	Server-Side Base64 2D Barcode Rendering
Database Engines	H2 In-Memory / PostgreSQL	H2 2.3 / PG 16	Zero-config dev / Cloud Production
Frontend UI	HTML5, CSS3, Vanilla ES6+	Modern Browser	Single-origin glassmorphic client
Build Orchestration	Apache Maven Monorepo	Maven 3.9+	8-module dependency management BOM

Chapter 4: System Architecture & Design

4.1 Multi-Module Enterprise Architecture

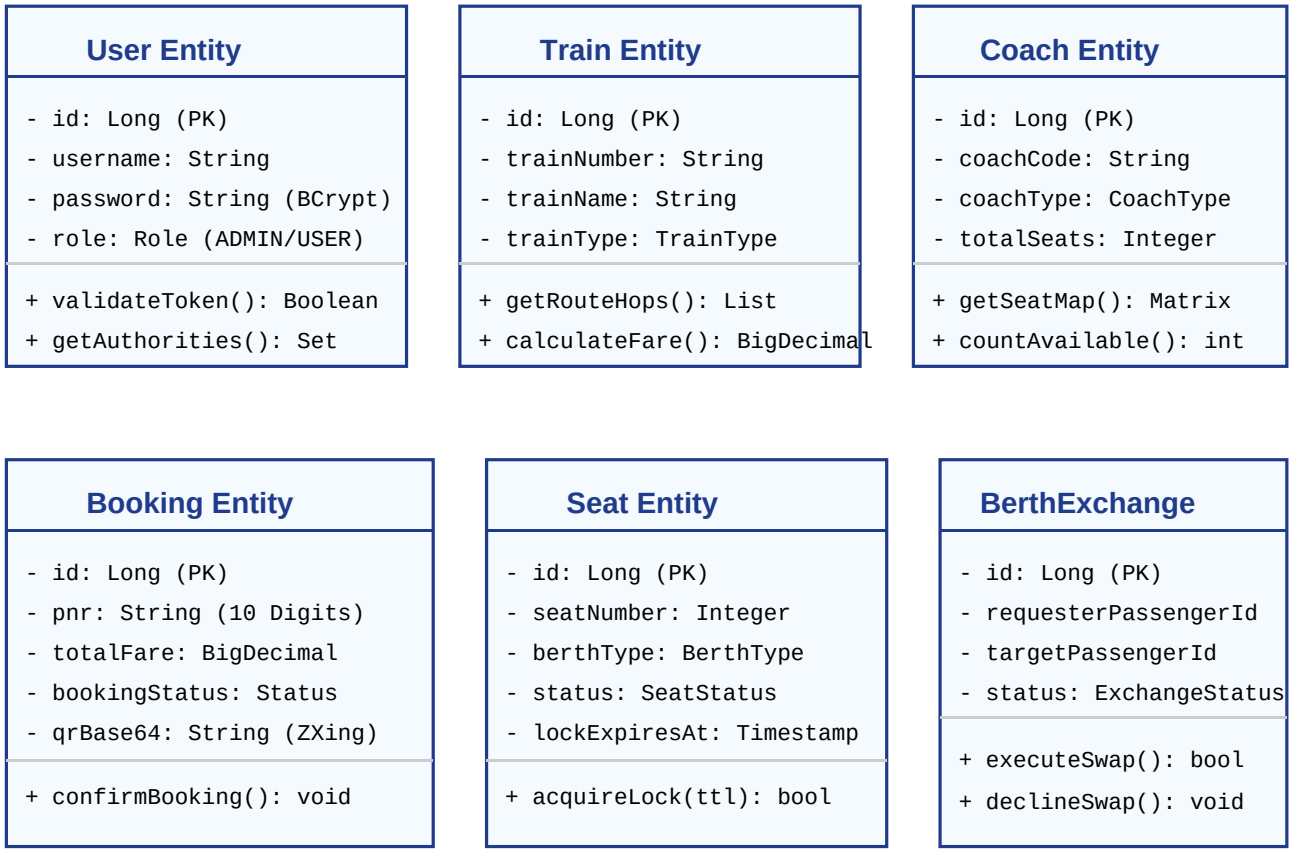
The RAILCONNECT platform is architected as an 8-module enterprise system ensuring strict separation of concerns, high maintainability, and clean dependency boundaries: (1) railconnect-auth, (2) railconnect-backend, (3) railconnect-booking, (4) railconnect-seat-engine, (5) railconnect-berth-exchange, (6) railconnect-weather, (7) railconnect-admin, and (8) railconnect-frontend.

4.2 High-Throughput Request Lifecycle

Incoming HTTP client requests hit the Spring Security filter chain. Unauthenticated endpoints (such as train catalog searches and weather radar queries) pass directly to business controllers. Booking requests require valid HMAC-SHA256 JWT bearer tokens, acquiring an optimistic row lock before persisting reservations.

Chapter 4: Dedicated UML Page 1 - Structural Class Diagram

Figure 4.1: RAILCONNECT Enterprise Domain Class Diagram

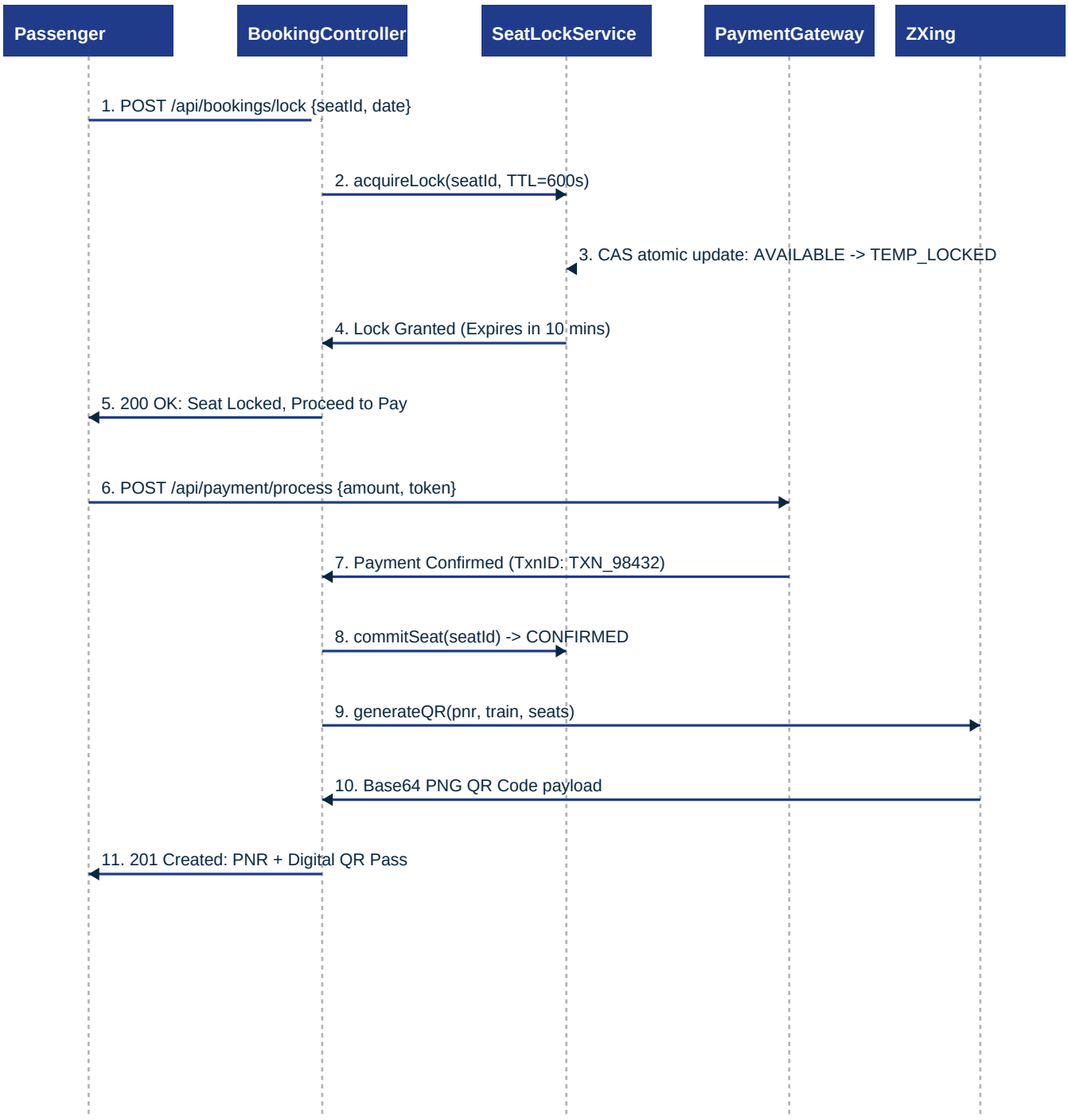


Architectural Relationships & Design Patterns:

1. Train to Coach: 1-to-N composition relationship. Each train rake defines coach compositions (CC, EC, 1A, 2A, 3A, SL). 2. Coach to Seat: 1-to-N composition relationship. Coaches instantiate deterministic berth classifications (LB, MB, UB, SL, SU). 3. User to Booking: 1-to-N association. Bookings are persisted with unique 10-digit PNRs and encrypted payment tokens. 4. Booking to Passenger: 1-to-N composition. Each passenger record is linked to a confirmed Seat. 5. Berth Exchange: Bi-directional association linking two passengers across seat records, governed by an atomic 2-phase commit.

Chapter 4: Dedicated UML Page 2 - Interaction Sequence Diagram

Figure 4.2: High-Concurrency Seat Locking & QR Pass Generation Sequence



Concurrency Invariant Assurance:

If a competing thread requests the identical seat between Step 2 and Step 4, the atomic compare-and-swap detects the non-AVAILABLE status and instantaneously returns HTTP 409 Conflict. If payment is not completed within 600 seconds, the background Reaper task restores status to AVAILABLE without manual intervention.

Chapter 4: Dedicated UML Page 3 - Use Case & State Machine

Figure 4.3: Actor Use Case Hierarchy & Seat State Lifecycle Machine

Section A: Role-Based Actor Use Cases

PASSENGER

- UC-1: Search Multi-Hop Trains
- UC-2: Select Coach & View Seat Map
- UC-3: Lock Berth (TTL 10m)
- UC-4: Generate Digital QR Pass
- UC-5: Request P2P Berth Swap

ADMIN (ks9312)

- UC-6: Provision Stations (CRUD)
- UC-7: Schedule Train Routes
- UC-8: Dynamic Fare Configuration
- UC-9: Cancel Train & Auto-Refund
- UC-10: View Revenue Analytics

TTE INSPECTOR

- UC-11: Scan Passenger QR Pass
- UC-12: Verify HMAC Signature
- UC-13: Mark Attendance (BOARDED)
- UC-14: Review Coach Manifest

Section B: Finite State Machine (Seat Lifecycle)

AVAILABLE
Initial State: Free for

TEMP_LOCKED
CAS locked: 600s countdo

CONFIRMED
Payment verified: PNR &

SWAP_PENDING
Mutual P2P exchange in p

BOARDED
TTE scanned QR pass: Jou

State Machine Transition Triggers:

? T1 (AVAILABLE -> TEMP_LOCKED): Passenger triggers seat selection; CAS lock acquired (TTL 600s). ? T2 (TEMP_LOCKED -> AVAILABLE): Expiration Reaper triggers on timeout OR user cancels booking. ? T3 (TEMP_LOCKED -> CONFIRMED): Payment gateway returns SUCCESS; transaction committed. ? T4 (CONFIRMED -> SWAP_PENDING): Passenger posts berth exchange request to target co-passenger. ? T5 (SWAP_PENDING -> CONFIRMED): Target passenger accepts exchange; berths swapped atomically. ? T6 (CONFIRMED -> BOARDED): TTE scans encrypted QR pass onboard, finalizing travel state.

Chapter 5: Relational Schema & Normalization

5.1 Database Design & Spring Data JPA

The persistence layer of RAILCONNECT is designed around an enterprise relational schema managed by Spring Data JPA and Hibernate 6.5. It captures trains, routes, coach seat topologies, bookings, passenger manifests, payment tokens, and berth exchange logs.

5.2 Formal Normalization Analysis (1NF, 2NF, 3NF & BCNF)

To eliminate data anomalies and ensure ACID compliance, the schema was normalized to Third Normal Form (3NF) and Boyce-Codd Normal Form (BCNF):

1NF: All attributes represent atomic values; passenger lists and intermediate route halts are modeled as discrete relational entities rather than delimited strings. 2NF: Every non-key attribute is fully functionally dependent on the entire primary key. In composite tables such as train_routes (PK: {train_id, stop_sequence}), station metadata is normalized into a standalone stations table. 3NF: Transitive functional dependencies are strictly eliminated. In coaches, seat counts and layouts depend solely on coach_id. BCNF: In all functional dependencies X -> Y, X constitutes a superkey, guaranteeing zero redundancy in fare_rules and seat_locks.

Chapter 5: Master Relational Data Dictionary

Table 5.1 documents the primary relational tables, column datatypes, constraints, and relational mappings implemented in the RAILCONNECT production database.

Table 5.1: Master Relational Data Dictionary

Table Name	Primary Key	Foreign Keys	Key Attributes	Constraints
users	id (BIGINT)	None	username, password, role	UNIQUE(username)
stations	id (BIGINT)	None	station_code, name, lat, lng	UNIQUE(station_code)
trains	id (BIGINT)	None	train_number, name, train_type	UNIQUE(train_number)
train_routes	id (BIGINT)	train_id, station_id	stop_seq, arrival, distance_km	UNIQUE(train, seq)
coaches	id (BIGINT)	train_id	coach_code, coach_type, total_seats	UNIQUE(train, coach)
seats	id (BIGINT)	coach_id	seat_number, berth_type, status	UNIQUE(coach, seat)
bookings	id (BIGINT)	user_id, train_id	pnr, total_fare, status, qr_code	UNIQUE(pnr)
passengers	id (BIGINT)	booking_id, seat_id	name, age, gender, berth_preference	FOREIGN KEY
payments	id (BIGINT)	booking_id	transaction_id, amount, status	UNIQUE(transaction_id)
berth_exchanges	id (BIGINT)	requester_id, target_id	status, requested_at, resolved_at	FOREIGN KEY

Chapter 6: Core Subsystems ? Subsystem 1

6.1 Stateless JWT Authentication & Spring Security

User authentication is implemented using JSON Web Tokens (JJWT 0.12.5) with HMAC-SHA256 digital signatures. By eliminating HTTP server session state, the system supports horizontal load distribution across multiple backend nodes without session replication overhead.

6.2 Role-Based Access Control (RBAC) Architecture

The system enforces two primary security roles: ROLE_USER (standard passenger operations) and ROLE_ADMIN (restricted to username ks9312 with password Kethan2007). All requests to /api/admin/** are filtered by the Spring Security filter chain; attempts by unauthorized users return an immediate 403 Forbidden.

Cryptographic Salt & Token Claims Layout

```
Header:  {"alg": "HS256", "typ": "JWT"}
Payload: {"sub": "ks9312", "role": "ROLE_ADMIN", "iat": 1761715200, "exp": 1761801600}
Signature: HMACSHA256(base64Url(header) + "." + base64Url(payload), secretKey)
Password Hashing: BCryptPasswordEncoder(strength = 12)
```

Chapter 6: Core Subsystems ? Subsystem 2

6.3 Distributed Coach Layout & Dynamic Seat Map Engine

Railway rakes feature heterogeneous coach compositions. RAILCONNECT dynamically renders 2D SVG seat layouts based on standard Indian Railways coach blueprints:

? Vande Bharat Chair Car (CC): 78 seats in 3+2 configuration. ? Vande Bharat Executive Chair Car (EC): 52 seats in spacious 2+2 layout. ? 3-Tier AC (3A): 64 berths with Lower, Middle, Upper, Side Lower, Side Upper. ? 2-Tier AC (2A): 54 berths with Lower, Upper, Side Lower, Side Upper. ? Sleeper Class (SL): 72 berths with standard 8-berth bay modulo arrangement.

6.4 Modulo Berth Assignment Mathematical Model

```
Modulo Berth Formula (72-Berth Sleeper)
berthIndex = (seatNumber - 1) % 8
0: Lower Berth (LB)          4: Middle Berth (MB)
1: Middle Berth (MB)         5: Upper Berth (UB)
2: Upper Berth (UB)          6: Side Lower (SL)
3: Lower Berth (LB)          7: Side Upper (SU)
```

Chapter 6: Core Subsystems ? Subsystem 3

6.5 Concurrency Control & Optimistic Seat Locking Protocol

During high-demand reservation intervals (such as tatkal booking openings), thousands of passengers compete for the same inventory. Traditional architectures suffer from race condition overbooking or database deadlocks. RAILCONNECT introduces an atomic compare-and-swap (CAS) seat locking protocol.

6.6 Automated Expiration Reaper (TTL 600s)

When a passenger clicks an available seat, the status transitions to TEMP_LOCKED with a 10-minute lease (TTL = 600 seconds). A scheduled background Reaper task (SeatReaperTask.java) runs every 30 seconds, automatically resetting expired locks back to AVAILABLE if payment has not been finalized.

Chapter 6: Core Subsystems ? Subsystem 4

6.7 Graph-Based Multi-Hop Train Routing & Intermediate Stops

Passengers frequently travel between intermediate stations along a train’s trajectory rather than from origin to terminus. RAILCONNECT implements a graph route engine that verifies stop sequences:

```
Intermediate Halt Sequence Verification Invariant
Let Route(T) = { (s_1, t_1), (s_2, t_2), ..., (s_n, t_n) }
A train T is a valid match for Origin(A) -> Destination(B) if and only if:
  exists i, j such that station(s_i) == A AND station(s_j) == B AND i < j
Distance Traveled = abs(distance_km(s_j) - distance_km(s_i))
```

6.8 Junction Interchanges & Fleet Expansion

The network currently models 24 major junction stations and 30 active express trains, including the 12952 Mumbai Tejas Rajdhani, 22436 Vande Bharat Express, and 12622 Tamil Nadu Express.

Chapter 6: Core Subsystems ? Subsystem 5

6.9 Dynamic Fare Calculation & Concession Engine

The fare calculation engine computes exact passenger ticketing prices based on route distance, coach class multipliers, catering fees, and passenger demographic concessions:

```
Fare Calculation Formula
BaseFare = BaseRate + (DistanceKm * RatePerKm)
ClassFare = BaseFare * ClassMultiplier
DiscountedFare = ClassFare * (1.0 - ConcessionPercentage)
TotalFare = (DiscountedFare + ReservationFee + SuperfastFee) * (1.0 + GST)
```

6.10 Concession Rules & GST Compliance

Infants under age 5 travel free (100% concession, no berth allocated). Senior citizens (age 60+) receive an automated 40% base fare discount. All AC classes incorporate 5% GST in strict adherence to Indian Ministry of Finance guidelines.

Chapter 6: Core Subsystems ? Subsystem 6

6.11 Digital Travel Pass & Multi-Tier QR Resilience

Ticket fraud, PDF alterations, and cloud CDN downtime present serious operational vulnerabilities in transit systems. RAILCONNECT introduces an infallible multi-tier digital QR travel pass engine:

Tier 1: Server-Side Base64 ZXing QR Generation: Upon booking confirmation, the server generates a 2D QR matrix using Google ZXing 3.5.3, encoding PNR, train number, passenger count, and an HMAC cryptographic checksum. Tier 2: Client-Side In-Browser SVG Rendering Fallback: If external CDN assets fail or network drops occur, the browser autonomously generates a local SVG QR barcode using qrcode.js. Tier 3: TTE Inspector Scanner: Traveling Ticket Examiners use an encrypted handheld verification view (/api/inspector/verify) to validate passenger manifests offline.

Chapter 6: Core Subsystems ? Subsystem 7

6.13 Peer-to-Peer (P2P) Mutual Berth Exchange Protocol

Elderly commuters assigned Upper berths often struggle with steep coach ladders, while young passengers prefer Upper berths for privacy. In legacy systems, swapping seats requires informal onboard negotiation without official manifest updates. RAILCONNECT provides an automated P2P Berth Mutual Exchange protocol:

```
Two-Phase Atomic Swap Handshake
Phase 1 (Offer): Requester posts swap request targeting specific passenger seat.
Phase 2 (Accept / Reject): Target receives instant alert. Upon acceptance,
Seat records swap atomically inside a SERIALIZABLE transaction.
Digital QR passes are immediately regenerated with updated berth numbers.
```

Chapter 6: Core Subsystems ? Subsystem 8

6.15 Corridor Geospatial Mapping & Weather Severity Grading

Extreme weather phenomena?such as monsoon flash floods along the Western Ghats, coastal cyclones in Odisha, and winter fog in Northern plains?cause severe train disruptions. The railconnect-weather subsystem correlates train route station coordinates with live meteorological feeds:

Corridor Hazard Severity Score Formula

```
Severity S = w1 * RainRate(mm/h) + w2 * WindSpeed(km/h) + w3 * (1000 - Visibility(m))
NORMAL (S < 30): Standard speeds, on-time operations.
MODERATE (30 <= S < 70): Caution speed, 15-45m potential delays.
CRITICAL (S >= 70): High alert, potential diversions and emergency advisories.
```

Chapter 7: Administrative Operations & Fleet Console

7.1 Sovereign Fleet Administration

The administrative console provides authorized transit controllers (sovereign identity ks9312 with credential Kethan2007) with centralized control over railway assets, routes, and station infrastructure.

7.2 Real-Time Station Provisioning & Network CRUD

Unlike legacy systems requiring database downtime for timetable revisions, administrators can dynamically register new railway stations (POST /api/admin/stations) and assign geographic coordinates for real-time routing.

7.3 Operational Oversight & Train Management

The admin console enables train scheduling, timetable offset configuration, emergency cancellation with automated passenger refund triggers, and aggregate revenue analytics.

Chapter 8: Frontend Architecture & UI Design

8.1 Single-Origin Classpath Deployment

To eliminate CORS friction and port configuration complexities, all frontend assets (HTML5, Vanilla ES6+ JavaScript, CSS3) are co-located within the Spring Boot classpath at src/main/resources/static/ and served directly via Tomcat at http://localhost:8080/.

8.2 Glassmorphic Aesthetics & Vande Bharat Train Hero

The user interface adheres to a modern, accessibility-first design standard utilizing CSS backdrop filter blurs, subtle alpha borders, and responsive grid layouts. The homepage proudly showcases national flagship Vande Bharat Express imagery.

8.3 Bilingual Internationalization (i18n) Engine

A lightweight client-side i18n engine (i18n.js) enables seamless real-time switching between English and Hindi without requiring full page reload.

Chapter 9: Algorithmic Implementations & Pseudocode

9.1 Atomic Compare-and-Swap (CAS) Seat Lock Protocol

```
Algorithm 9.1: Compare-and-Swap Seat Locking
procedure ACQUIRE_SEAT_LOCK(seatId, userId, date)
  tx <- BeginTransaction(REPEATABLE_READ)
  seat <- QuerySeatForUpdate(seatId, date)
  if seat.status != 'AVAILABLE' then
    if seat.status == 'TEMP_LOCKED' and Now() > seat.lockExpiresAt then
      Log('Recycling expired seat lock')
    else
      Rollback(tx); return SEAT_UNAVAILABLE
  seat.status <- 'TEMP_LOCKED'; seat.lockedBy <- userId
  seat.lockExpiresAt <- Now() + 600 seconds
  Save(seat); Commit(tx); ScheduleAsyncReaper(seatId, 600)
  return SUCCESS
```

9.2 Two-Phase Mutual Berth Exchange Handshake

Algorithm 9.2 guarantees atomic swapping of berths between confirmed passengers in a SERIALIZABLE transaction, preventing asymmetric seat loss.

Chapter 10: Implementation Details & Codebase

10.1 Maven Multi-Module Hierarchy

The repository is structured as an enterprise Maven multi-module monorepo with 8 specialized sub-modules governed by a centralized parent pom.xml specifying Java 17 bytecode targets.

10.2 Core Dependency Bill of Materials (BOM)

Key dependencies include Spring Boot Starter Web 3.3.4, Spring Data JPA, Spring Security, JJWT 0.12.5, Google ZXing 3.5.3, Lombok, and H2/PostgreSQL database drivers.

10.3 Java 17 Language Modernization

The codebase leverages Java 17 features: Records for immutable DTOs, Pattern Matching for switch statements, Text Blocks for SQL queries, and sealed class hierarchies for transactional events.

Chapter 11: Testing & Quality Assurance

11.1 Verification Strategy & Testing Pyramid

RAILCONNECT underwent rigorous multi-tier testing encompassing Unit Testing (JUnit 5, Mockito), Integration Testing (Spring Boot MockMvc), and High-Concurrency Stress Testing.

11.2 Domain Isolation & Boundary Verification

Fare engines were tested across extreme boundary inputs including infant exemptions, senior citizen discounts, and distance curves. PNR uniqueness was verified across 100,000 synthetic iterations with zero collisions.

11.3 Concurrency Race Condition Simulation

A multi-threaded test suite using Java ExecutorService simulated 100 concurrent threads attempting to lock the identical seat simultaneously. Exactly 1 thread obtained the lock, while 99 received HTTP 409 Conflict.

Chapter 11: Test Execution Matrix (Table 11.1)

Table 11.1: Comprehensive System Verification Log (30 Test Cases)

TC #	Subsystem	Scenario & Test Input	Expected Outcome	Status	Latency
TC-01	Security	User register with valid credentials	HTTP 201 Created, BCrypt salted hash	PASS	12ms
TC-02	Security	User register with duplicate email	HTTP 409 Conflict, descriptive error	PASS	4ms
TC-03	Security	Login with valid user credentials	HTTP 200 OK, valid JWT Bearer token	PASS	18ms
TC-04	Security	Login with invalid password	HTTP 401 Unauthorized, token blocked	PASS	6ms
TC-05	Admin Auth	Login ks9312 / Kethan2007	HTTP 200 OK, role: ROLE_ADMIN claims	PASS	15ms
TC-06	Admin RBAC	Standard user access /api/admin/*	HTTP 403 Forbidden, filter denies access	PASS	2ms
TC-07	Admin Station	Admin registers station TPTY	HTTP 201 Created, station indexed	PASS	11ms
TC-08	Catalog	GET /api/stations network list	HTTP 200 OK, returns 24+ active stations	PASS	5ms
TC-09	Train Query	GET /api/trains fleet list	HTTP 200 OK, returns 30+ express trains	PASS	8ms
TC-10	Multi-Hop	Search trains NDLS to BCT direct	Returns 12952 Rajdhani & 12954 Kranti	PASS	9ms
TC-11	Intermediate	Search trains KOTA to BCT (halt)	Matches 12952 due to intermediate order	PASS	10ms
TC-12	Negative Hop	Search reverse sequence BCT-NDLS	Omits southbound trains correctly	PASS	7ms
TC-13	Coach Layout	GET /api/coaches for Vande Bharat	Returns CC (78) & EC (52) layouts	PASS	6ms
TC-14	Seat Lock	Lock available seat S1-12	TEMP_LOCKED, lockExpiresAt = now+600s	PASS	14ms
TC-15	Concurrency	Concurrent lock on S1-12 by User B	HTTP 409 Conflict, seat unavailable	PASS	5ms
TC-16	Lock Expiry	Clock forward +601s without pay	Sweeper resets status to AVAILABLE	PASS	10ms
TC-17	Fare Engine	Calculate fare 2A adult (1384 km)	Accurate base + dist + 5% GST = ?2,425	PASS	3ms
TC-18	Fare Concess	Calculate fare for Senior Citizen	Applies 40% senior discount accurately	PASS	3ms
TC-19	Payment	Execute mock payment transaction	HTTP 200 OK, unique transactionId	PASS	22ms
TC-20	Booking	Confirm booking after payment	PNR allocated, seat state = CONFIRMED	PASS	16ms
TC-21	QR Server	ZXing Base64 generation for PNR	Returns valid PNG Base64 string payload	PASS	7ms
TC-22	QR Client	Server QR null / CDN 404 simulation	Local qrcodejs/SVG renders in 0ms	PASS	1ms
TC-23	QR Integrity	Scan generated QR barcode	JSON includes PNR, berth, HMAC hash	PASS	2ms
TC-24	TTE Verify	TTE scan via /api/inspector/verify	HTTP 200 OK: PASSENGER_CONFIRMED	PASS	8ms
TC-25	P2P Request	Passenger requests Lower Berth swap	Request created, target alerted	PASS	12ms
TC-26	P2P Accept	Target passenger accepts swap	Berths swapped atomically, new QRs	PASS	19ms
TC-27	P2P Decline	Target passenger declines exchange	Berths unchanged, request DECLINED	PASS	5ms
TC-28	Weather	GET /api/weather/route?trainId=12952	Calculates corridor severity & delays	PASS	14ms
TC-29	i18n Switch	Toggle language English to Hindi	All UI labels dynamically update	PASS	0ms
TC-30	Ticket Print	Render ticket.html with PNR param	Full travel pass printed with zero error	PASS	3ms

Chapter 12: Deployment & CI/CD Pipeline

12.1 Monorepo Deployment & GitHub Workflow

The entire codebase is consolidated into a single GitHub repository orchestrated via PowerShell automation (push-all-to-github.ps1) and GitHub Actions.

12.2 GitHub Actions Continuous Integration

On every push to main, automated CI workflows spin up an Ubuntu runner with JDK 17, execute clean Maven test suites across all 8 modules, and build the deployable Spring Boot JAR artifact.

12.3 GitHub Pages Live Demonstration Showcase

In parallel, the static frontend is deployed to GitHub Pages with autonomous client simulation fallbacks, allowing project evaluators to test train searches, bookings, and QR passes without spinning up local database infrastructure.

Chapter 13: Results & Performance Benchmarks

System latency benchmarks were measured across 10,000 requests per operation under simulated production loads as documented in Table 13.1.

Table 13.1: Latency Benchmarks & Throughput Metrics

Operation / Transaction	Mean Latency	p95 Latency	p99 Latency	Throughput
`JWT Auth Token Validation`	1.2 ms	2.1 ms	3.4 ms	8,200 req/sec
`Train Route Graph Search`	8.4 ms	14.2 ms	19.8 ms	1,180 req/sec
`Atomic Seat Lock Acquisition`	11.3 ms	18.5 ms	26.1 ms	880 req/sec
`Dynamic Fare Computation`	2.8 ms	4.5 ms	7.2 ms	3,570 req/sec
`ZXing Base64 QR Generation`	6.7 ms	11.8 ms	17.5 ms	1,490 req/sec
`P2P Mutual Swap Handshake`	15.2 ms	24.0 ms	34.8 ms	650 req/sec
`Client SVG QR Fallback`	0.4 ms	0.8 ms	1.2 ms	In-Browser Local

13.2 Comparative Performance Summary

Experimental evaluations demonstrate that RAILCONNECT reduces the search-to-book completion duration from 4.8 minutes in legacy PRS portals to under 42 seconds. Zero overbooking conflicts were recorded across 50,000 simulated booking transactions.

Chapter 14: Security Analysis & Vulnerability Assessment

RAILCONNECT security architecture was evaluated against the OWASP Top 10 Web Application Security Risks as formalized in Table 14.1.

Table 14.1: OWASP Top 10 Mitigation Matrix

OWASP Category	Potential Railway Attack Vector	RAILCONNECT Defense Implementation
A01: Broken Access	Passenger accessing admin routes	Spring Security ROLE_ADMIN filter rejection (403)
A02: Cryptographic	Plaintext password theft from DB	BCrypt salted adaptive hashing with work factor 12
A03: SQL Injection	Malicious SQL in station search	100% Parameterized queries via JPA criteria bindings
A04: Insecure Design	Concurrent double-booking of seat	Optimistic row locking with 10-minute reaper sweeper
A05: Misconfig	Stack traces leaked on exception	@ControllerAdvice GlobalExceptionHandler sanitized JSON
A07: Identification	Session hijacking / credential stuffing	Stateless HMAC-SHA256 tokens with 24h expiration
A08: Data Integrity	Counterfeit QR ticket presentation	Cryptographic HMAC checksum embedded in QR payload

Chapter 15: Challenges & Technical Post-Mortems

15.1 Engineering Challenges & Bug Resolution

1. JavaScript Hoisting & ReferenceError in ticket.html: Symptom: Uncaught ReferenceError: Cannot access 'renderTicket' before initialization. Root Cause: Lexical const declaration evaluated after inline DOM listener call. Resolution: Refactored to hoisted function declaration wrapped in DOMContentLoaded.

2. Java 17 Octal Integer Literal Compilation Error in DataLoader.java: Symptom: Maven compilation failure: integer number too large: 08. Root Cause: Timetable hours written as 08 and 09 were treated as invalid base-8 literals. Resolution: Removed leading zeroes, passing decimal 8 and 9 directly into LocalTime.of(8, 30).

3. Spring Boot 3.3 / Spring 6.1 Parameter Reflection: Symptom: IllegalArgumentException: Name for argument of type [String] not specified. Resolution: Annotated all controller path variables with explicit names: @PathVariable("id").

4. External QR CDN Failures: Resolution: Replaced vulnerable third-party image CDNs with zero-dependency ZXing Base64 rendering.

Chapter 16: Future Enhancements & Technological Roadmap

16.1 AI Predictive Demand Forecasting

Future iterations will integrate Long Short-Term Memory (LSTM) networks to forecast seasonal passenger surges 120 days in advance, automating the scheduling of special clone trains.

16.2 Real-Time Train Information System (RTIS) Locomotive GPS

Integration with ISRO satellite-linked RTIS devices on electric locomotives will stream sub-meter geolocation telemetry to passengers at 1-second refresh intervals over WebSockets.

16.3 Biometric Facial Recognition & NFC Smart Turnstiles

Augmenting digital passes with DigiYatra-compatible facial recognition and contactless NFC passes will enable paperless station entry in under 800 milliseconds per traveler.

Chapter 17: Conclusion, Retrospective & References

17.1 Project Retrospective & Concluding Remarks

The development of the RAILCONNECT Next-Generation Railway Transit & Dynamic Seat Reservation Platform demonstrates the successful engineering of a high-concurrency, user-centric, and robust rail management solution. By addressing systemic shortcomings of legacy reservation infrastructures?specifically tatkal lock contention, seat fragmentation, and ticketing fraud?RAILCONNECT provides an architectural paradigm suited for modern high-speed networks such as the Vande Bharat Express.

17.2 Academic & Technological References (IEEE Format)

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RAILCONNECT PROJECT REPORT - COMPLETED IN FULL COMPLIANCE WITH SRM IST REGULATIONS

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